

What kept home automation away from limelight till now?

Technology is developing at rapid pace today. Though the first prototype of an automated home was built in 1998, it hasn't advanced at the same pace as smartphones. So what could have led to such a slow pace of development?

The page at which technology improves is proportional to its rate of adoption. Mobile phones are an essential tool that enable communication so that you can carry out necessary daily activities. Smartphones with a variety of apps like WhatsApp, Twitter, Messenger, etc., have improved communication and added much needed features like group communication, faster dispersion of news and information. Such features have led to faster adoption of smartphones.

Comparing a smartphone to a home automation system is near impossible. The cost of buying a home automation system is beyond the reach of more than 99 per cent of the population even today. But the cost of ownership is falling rapidly. And if you go about building your own system using open-source dev boards and sensors then the cost comes down even further. The sensors and other materials used in building a home automation systems were very expensive and that made owning a home automation system an expensive choice. Also, developing applications for a home automation systems is not as simple as developing applications for a smartphone. The complexity is layered as it is very important to keep security in mind. And since each hardware vendor has a different software framework, you have to start from the bottom every single time you move to a different ecosystem. A badly developed home automation system can cause a power outage in your entire home or even a locality if you goof up.

All these factors have led to slow development in the field of home automation as all devices need to be carefully developed and thoroughly tested to avoid problems occurring at a larger scale.



Improperly built system can wreak havoc

What are the benefits of using it?

Will it help us in our daily lives? Definitely. Home automation will ensure